

MAJOR RESEARCH PROJECT

ON

THE EFFECT OF BRAND TRIBALISM ON BRAND LOVE



IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT FOR THE

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

SCHOOL OF STUDIES IN MANAGEMENT, JIWAJI UNIVERSITY

GWALIOR, (M.P.)

SUBMITTED BY: -

KRISHAN CHAND OJHA

ROLL NO: - 181073143

CLASS: - MBA IV SEMESTER

BATCH: - 2018-20

SUBMITTED TO:-

Prof. Suvijna Awasthi Ma'am

Head And Dean

SOS Management

Jiwaji University, Gwalior

DECLARATION

I, Mr. **KRISHAN CHAND OJHA**, student of MBA IV Semester of School of Studies in Management, Jiwaji University, Gwalior, hereby declare that the major research project entitled **“THE EFFECT OF BRAND TRIBALISM ON BRAND LOVE”** is submitted by me in the line of partial fulfillment of course objectives for the Masters of Business Administration Degree.

I assure that this major research project is the result of my own efforts and that any other institute for the award of any degree or diploma has not submitted it.

Date:

Name

Place:

MBA IV Semester

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that Mr. **KRISHAN CHAND OJHA**, student of MBA IV Semester of School of Studies in Management, Jiwaji University, Gwalior, has successfully completed his major research project. He has prepared this report titled **“THE EFFECT OF BRAND TRIBALISM ON BRAND LOVE”** under my direct supervision and guidance.

Dr. Prerana Baber

(Faculty Guide)

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, Mr. KRISHAN CHAND OJHA, “Acknowledgement is an art, one can write glib stanzas without meaning a word, on the other hand one can make a simple expression of gratitude.” Before getting to brass tacks of things. I would like to add a heartfelt word for the people who have helped me in bringing out the creativeness of this project.

To commence with things I would like to take this opportunity to gratefully and humbly thanks to Dr. Prerana Baber, Project guide, MAJOR RESEARCH PROJECT ON THE EFFECT OF BRAND TRIBALISM ON BRAND LOVE, for being appreciative enough by giving me an opportunity to undertake this project.

My parents need special mentions here for their constant support and love in my life. I also thank my friends and well-wishers, who have provided their whole hearted support to me in this exercise. I believe that this endeavor has prepared me for taking up new challenging opportunities in future.

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Brands are omnipresent; they penetrate almost every aspect of our life: economic, social, cultural, sporting, even religion. Due to its tendency to pervade everywhere they have come under growing criticism. In postmodern societies where individuals want to give name to their consumption, brands can and should be analysed through various perspectives: macroeconomics; microeconomics, sociology, anthropology, history, semiotics, philosophy and so on. Though the concept of brand and branding has been debated recently as a major topic of study in marketing discipline but they are almost as old as civilization. Old civilization of Mesopotamia and Greek used marks and names to identify or indicate their offerings - predominantly of wines, ointments, pots or metals. The word brand is derived from Old Norse word brand, which means "to burn" (an identifying mark burned on livestock with a heated iron) as brands were and still are the means by which owners of livestock mark their animals to identify them. Due to lack of a common understanding on brand complexity increases in brand interpretation as well as its management. Therefore, it becomes very necessary to understand the very nature of brand for creating, developing and protecting brands and business in general. Brands are a direct consequence of the strategy of market segmentation and product differentiation. Branding means more than just giving name and signalling to the outside world that such a product or service has been stamped with the mark and imprint of an organization. Branding consists in transforming the product category; it requires a corporate long term involvement, a high level of resources and skills.

The word "Tribe" has been borrowed from anthropology, which was used to describe old societies, in which social order was maintained without any central power. The notion of tribe is generally used in politics to explain any collective behaviour. On the other hand, "Tribe" also expresses the same characteristics as the "ethnic group" but it is on the smaller scale (e.g. local, linguistic and cultural homogeneity). Similarly, it describes the same characteristics as of "clan" but it is on the larger scale (e.g. Kinship, lineage and other blood relations). Furthermore, Cove and Cove drew on Mafiosi to introduce the term tribal in the modern consumer society to researchers and marketers and the focal point in it is that need

for community and social connectedness has developed into the priority over the materialistic consumption of objects.

Effect of Brand Tribalism on Satisfaction and Loyalty Brands can be used to satisfy psychological needs. Brands can also serve social purposes by reflecting social ties such as one's family, community, and cultural groups. As symbols, brands can add to or reinforce the way the consumer thinks about him or herself. Thus, the set of brand associations create and define consumer's self-concept. Reference group usage of a brand provides user image associations as well as psychological benefit associations for brands. Consumers construct themselves and present themselves to others through their brand. As a result, the set of brand associations is linked to the consumer's mental representation of self. Thus, the meaning and value of a brand is not only its ability to express the self but also its role in facilitating customers to create and build self-identities through developing connections to brands. Sheath has proposed that customers select brands in order to satisfy their specific values. Further, Cove and Cove (2001) and Cove (1997) have concluded that in order to satisfy the desire for communion, tribally based consumers look out products/services more for their "linking value" rather than for utility. Thus, customers, to satisfy their desire for communities, postmodern individuals seek products and services less for their use value than for their linking value. Similarly, customers seek satisfaction through emotions shared with others, through being with them. As customers become more involved in a product support community, they are likely to become more loyal to that product. Moving to a different brand imposes two costs on the customer. First, switching costs of learning a new or unfamiliar product without the support of the community could be daunting. Second, users will suffer social costs in lost connections with the previous group have proved that the feeling of belonging to a brand community can have consumer loyalty. Likewise, Clemons have argued that building loyalty through fantasy-oriented communities does not seem impossible, but has yet to prove very fruitful.

Tribal membership is fluid and can fluctuate according to the involvement of the individual. This poses a challenge for marketers in identifying and building long-term loyal relationships with individuals. Firms supporting consumer-consumer relationships, such as consumer tribes, are proposed to create long-term loyalty through establishing both an emotional connection as well as a rational reason for commitment. In many publications, loyal

relationship between customers and companies are seen as an investment for the future revenue and competitive advantage. And the value of loyalty, a commitment of re-consume is shown by the difficulty other firms have in copying this relationship. However, the concept of loyalty may have limited value in the case of post-modern consumption. The context, product and an individual's experiences do not produce one tribal form of loyalty that will have re-consumption commitment. In this situation, it is required that aggregate tribal members' loyalty to a formation of loyalty. And the formation of loyalty should concern the influence of social identity and social context.

According to Bhattacharya et al. theory, social identity theory is used to structure the commitments of repurchase from a social group (tribe) as a form identification with the brand. It is also referred to as "bonded loyalty", where people show a collective loyalty towards a brand or company.

Concept of "cultural capital" may explain the knowledge, rules and chain of command within a tribe. In the tribal context, cultural capital "consists of a set of socially rare and distinctive tastes, skills, knowledge and practices". A tribal marketing approach needs company to act in a support role to the relationships within a group with the aim being to build bonded loyalty, rather than to act as a controller. In this view, an understanding of the specific cultural capital of a tribe, and its symbolic meaning would support marketers to hobnob with tribal people and build a collective, bonded loyalty. And also it could "provide insight into ways of engaging members in the co-creation of products and, more importantly, the experiences they deliver".

The social dynamics of tribes also provide insight for connecting with members on an affective level. Cove and Cove found four different roles to exist amongst consumer tribe members. These range from low participation (the sympathiser), to active members, to practitioners and lastly devotees, who possess high level of involvement and emotional attachment. The practitioner in a tribe has a similarity with the opinion leader concept; they influence the exchange of certain information among peers due to their own knowledge and authority in the area. In a post-modern consumer tribal context, it is fitting to use King and summer's description of opinion leaders as people with influence over the exchange of certain information. The roles members assume may have implications for whom, and how, marketers choose to communicate with the tribe.

This piece of work reveals the details of tribal membership and evaluates the influence of this membership on consumption behaviour. It is not like conventional segmentation where consumers are arbitrarily grouped by segment characteristics, tribes are consumer-driven groups that members in tribes construct an individual's self-identity and create new communities based on shared consumption, beliefs, passion and ideas. In this view, it can be found that tribal relationship is primarily founded based on affective rather than on rational or commercial bases. In this condition, building a long term relationship with tribal members requires that consider the influence of social identity and social context on the formation of loyalty. As revealed by Bhattacharya et al. (1995), this kind of loyalty is referred to "bonded loyalty". Then the understanding of defined values of social dynamic of tribes and a specific set of "culture capital" provide a way for marketers to reach tribal members and develop a collective, bonded loyalty.

Finally, although subculture and brand tribe have similar features, it is still hard to say they are the same thing. According to Schiffman et al (2008)'s theory, relationships between members of brand tribe are much narrow. In this view, we can see that though their connection is also built in a similar way of gathering people together, the main bond of brand tribe is shared consumption while subculture's main bond can be everything.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Brand love is defined as “the degree of passionate emotional attachment a satisfied consumer has for a particular brand.” And generally focuses on a consumer’s strong affection for a specific brand. These feelings result in consumption behaviours that include seeking information on the brand and fostering positive attitudes toward it. Brand love leads consumers to spend their time and money willingly. Consumers who love a specific brand involve themselves deeply with it. They also develop a relationship with the brand through long-term periods and are willing to express their passion and identity through the integration of their brand [3]. Consumers tend to develop a close relationship with brands that are connected to their self-image and are likely to identify with them. They rarely consider another brand in order to stay committed in maintaining a positive biased response toward the brand they have connected with. It is because their focus on a particular brand is affective rather than cognitive. Strong emotional response leads to more satisfaction with a brand and facilitates accommodation for the brand. Thus, emotional bond, which is brand love, is a superior predictor of the consistent attention and contribution toward the brand. More recently, academic literature on brand love has tried to consider variables related to community behaviour. Like-minded consumers desire to get together with others to validate their love for the same brand. A brand community is formed based on a consumer’s emotional attachment to a product or brand and a shared passion among community members for it. Empirical research also addresses brand attachment as an antecedent of tribalism by testing its sequential model. Consumers who are emotionally attached to a brand, share information related to the brand and form bonds with other members who have the same enthusiasm for the brand. Therefore, we anticipate that emotional bond considered as brand love has a positive effect upon the tendency toward communal behaviours, such as tribalism. Emotional bond is a critical component in forming not only brand love, but also tribalism. Tribes are unique loci for those with shared passions to link with like-minded people who care for the

brand [8]. The connection with the brand is a foundation that allows independent consumers to bond with community members. Therefore, when brand users develop a positive relationship, both, with the brand and the tribe, they get more satisfaction. Recent literature has also recognized tribalism as a mediator. Brand attachment fosters self-esteem through tribalism, resulting in positive purchase intention, recruitment, and word-of-mouth publicity. Therefore, we suggest brand tribalism as a mediate variable. We assume that brand love has a positive direct effect, as well as an indirect effect through brand tribalism, on satisfaction. Moreover, given that fashion brands offer a strong tool for representing one's self-concept, we expect to show a distinct effect of tribalism within this industry in our study. A study of brand love has suggested a positive relationship between self-expressive brands and WOM, but this relationship has remained largely unexplored in the academic literature. Given the importance of understanding WOM behaviour, and consistent with the limited previous research on self-expressive brands, we posit that those who consume self-expressive brands are more likely to talk to others about the brand.

Moreover, the study invited respondents to name their favourite fashion brand, and to respond to the questionnaire thinking about that brand. We note earlier in our paper that brands named revealed four broad categories: clothing and accessory brands, retail brands, sports brands and gadgets. We advocate further research to investigate whether different categories of fashion brands, result in different relationships between SUSCEP, SNI, self-expressive brands and brand tribalism, and the brand outcomes brand love and WOM.

Emotions are precursors, involved in, and outcomes of buyer behaviour. For example, both donors and recipients experience positive and negative emotions before, during, and after the gifting event. Researchers argue that all important decisions have emotional consequences; in this vein, emotions inform decision making or alternatively, may interfere with or postpone decisions involving trade-offs. Arguments suggest that compared to cognition, affect is more effectual at predicting behaviour. Consumers have been shown to use emotions in responding to advertising content, while other findings show the strengthening of brand relationships via emotional rather Than factual advertising content. Further, consumers may scrutinize feelings for indicators as to whether to approach or avoid. Emotions too, have been examined as a discrete but continuous, multi-dimensional process. Mehrabian and Russell's seminal PAD (pleasure–arousal–dominance) framework is a fitting

example. Here, emotional response includes pleasure (i.e., the valence of the felt emotion), arousal (i.e., the action-orientation of the emotion, where circumstance leads to experienced emotion), and dominance (i.e., the emotion's control over a person's thoughts and behaviours for the duration of the emotion). Defined as experienced pleasure of being associated with a brand, brand pride is conceptually linked to brand tribalism, as contagious pride (i.e., collective-expression), vicarious pride (i.e., creation of the collective self), conspicuous pride (i.e., self-expression), and introspective pride (i.e., creation of the individual self) are unremittingly paraded in such brand circles. These brand pride elements are on display among fans at sporting events, especially across collegiate football venues on game day. Although considered a significant influencer of consumer behaviour, determinants and outcomes of brand pride have been under-examined in marketing. Of value here, understanding factors that bolster fans' team-related brand pride is an important topic for sports marketers. There is pride in being a fan of a collegiate football team, which brand tribalism components (e.g., sense of community, defines of the tribal brand) may intensify. In general, the literature related to brand tribalism reveals favourable pecuniary outcomes of brand tribe membership. For example, such affiliation increases purchase intentions and brand value. Brand tribe elements also boost consumers'/fans' pride in their beloved brand. As Helm et al. found, brand identification, which is linked to define of the tribal brand, relates positively to brand pride. Also, brand love, captured within the brand pride measure, is explained by sense of community, affective brand experience, and brand identification.

Members of a brand tribe are fixed in a hearty emotional bond to such an entity, whether product or brand. Importantly, brand tribes are differentiated from brand communities in that tribes do not control consumers' lives, are playful rather than stanch, are ephemeral, and are entrepreneurial. In the postmodern sense, the brand becomes venerated for its ability to fuse consumers with some sense of social hierarchy, thus a tribe. The idiom 'tribe' therefore denotes a person's return to the religious values of elfin bucolic communities, a collective value system, a sense of fitting in, and an ethnocentric perspective of us versus them. With dyadic communication and emotional exchange as central components of the brand tribal relationship, tribal consumption is based more on social connecting, hedonic-based value than utilitarian equity. To illustrate, online social network influence and a predilection for

interpersonal influence ante cede brand tribalism; beguilingly, consumers may in fact show more loyalty to the tribe they belong to than the brand it represents.

Brand tribalism has relevance to a study of self-expressive brands, as tribalism considers the degree of connectedness between consumers and brands, and suggests self-expressive benefits from the shared experience of brand consumption. Brand tribes refer to “a network of societal micro-groups in which individuals share strong emotional links, a common subculture and a vision of life”. The concept of brand tribalism is centred on the use of symbolism to demonstrate a member’s allegiance to the group. It is acknowledged that tribes are about shared passion, which can result in a “parallel social universe (subculture) with its own myths, values, rituals, vocabulary and hierarchy”. Traditionally, most literature revolving around communal behaviours has focused on brand communities. A brand community refers to a “specialized, non-geographically bound community, based on a structured set of social relationships among the admirers of the brand.” By sharing interests and information about a brand and by interacting with other consumers, brand community members learn unique customs and traditions, feel a sense of responsibility toward the other members and the community as a whole. Thus, communities are recognized by their nature of mutual identification and co-creation of meaning. Community members usually have lots of product knowledge and talk about the introduction of new products, marketing campaigns, and even share new ideas for the development of new products. Sometimes because of the expression of members’ emotional commitment through action, the company relinquishes control over the brand’s meaning. Brand communities have been investigated in diverse categories such as motorcycles, video games, and breakfast confectionaries. However, studies on brand communities do not reflect characteristics of postmodern consumers that are multiple, playful, fragmented, or illogical. In this regard, brand tribes offer a better understanding not only of the changeable nature of preferences, but also of symbolic consumption. A brand tribe is defined as “a network of heterogeneous persons who are interlinked by a shared passion and emotion.” Although it seems similar to brand communities or subcultures, brand tribes obviously differ from these in that members are multiple, playful, and transient, and play a leading role in co-creating brand value as entrepreneurs. Whereas subcultures do not admit to the destruction of their dominant culture and brand communities look for iconic brands as

a place for brand experience, tribes do not do either of these. To tribes, linking value is more important than what is being consumed. The brand is not for utility, but for hedonic value. Brands are not just consumable objects anymore, based on individual emotional bonds, but are symbols themselves that represent a tribe's unique identities or linking values. Companies no longer create and embed value through their ability to produce and design products. Instead, consumers serve as active co-creators of the value of a brand. Thus, tribal consumption stands out in self-expressive brands such as fashion brands.

The study also investigates the relationship between tribalism and brand loyalty. Previous literature suggests that feeling part of a group through brand consumption offers value to both the brand and the consumer. This value is demonstrated through loyalty to the brand. In 2009, stated the need for additional research to explore the relationship between brand tribalism and brand loyalty. A recent study focusing on brand communities, found that brand loyalty is predominantly influenced by identification with the brand community. However, there are a number of distinctions between brand communities and brand tribes that suggest further exploration of brand tribal outcomes is warranted. Brand communities form for longer periods of time than brand tribes and do not interact with other groups, which could influence loyalty behaviours. By contrast, interaction with others is an important characteristic of brand tribes. Further, unlike brand communities, tribes do not dominate consumer's lives and membership to one tribe does not mean these consumers cannot be members of others. Therefore it is possible that tribal consumers may be more fickle. Brand tribes are also described as being "playful" and "loose", as unlike brand communities, brand tribalism does not require that the consumer remains tied to one brand for a long period of time. Additionally, in contrast to brand communities which form for long time periods, brand tribes are transient, and form around a shared interest for a short period of time before dispersing when this interest alters. Therefore, it is possible that consumers' interest in brands wanes when the tribe disperses.

REVIEW

The consumer-brand relationship has been illuminated as a robust variable that can predict consistent purchase intention and word-of-mouth publicity. More recently, research has focused on the community effect influence on consumers beyond a manager's brand control. Although many studies suggest that community behaviours create positive outcomes for

companies, such as purchase intention, brand loyalty, and brand commitment, there is a limited understanding of the behaviour of fickle consumers in the postmodern society. Therefore, we considered the tribalism variable with strong consumer-brand relationship to represent brand love. Furthermore, self-presentation, which is an important psychological motivation in consumption, is also included in our model. Finally, using previous review literature try to find out, the direct effect of brand love on brand satisfaction and the mediating effect of brand tribalism between brand love and consumer satisfaction. Thus, we aimed to address the mechanism of brand tribalism and brand love with self-presentation by testing our hypothetical model. The results showed a direct effect of brand love on satisfaction and an indirect effect of tribalism between brand love and satisfaction. Although the consumer-brand relationship still had a robust positive effect on satisfaction, we could confirm the mediating effect of brand tribalism. Both, brand love and tribalism, facilitated consumer satisfaction. Therefore, consumers who are attached to a focal brand tend to seek tribal membership, which increases their brand satisfaction. Furthermore, we suggested self-presentation as a moderator of mediation. The results showed that when consumers have high self-presentation, they are more likely to be satisfied with the brand through tribalism. However, when consumers have low self-presentation, this effect does not exist. Thus, the model of brand love on satisfaction through tribalism was moderated by self-presentation, which is a desire to express one's identity. In turn, self-presentation amplified the mediating effect of tribalism on consumer satisfaction.

Both Variables has several practical and academic implications. In the current marketing environment, where customized strategies are used, given its findings on brand tribalism, this study is expected to contribute to market segmentation and strategy in sport brand marketing. More interestingly, we found that self-presentation could facilitate the effect of tribalism. Given that a considerable number of theories centre round self-presentation, we contribute to the literature by establishing the brand tribalism concept as a mediating variable. For example, tribalism is well recognized in self-expressive brands, such as fashion and online gaming. Brand tribes prefer a brand that represents their unique identity, distinguished from the identities others. Additionally, we suggest that self-presentation provides an insight to marketers that they can use to formulate strategies for tribal marketing based on the theory that consumers with greater self-presentation tend to use social networking services more than those with lesser self-presentation. In other words, this study

implies that marketing managers need to consider either a consumer's self-expression needs or the self-expressive functions of consumer goods in brands to succeed in tribal marketing, which means that they must work toward enhancing consumer satisfaction by emphasizing on the consumption patterns of reference groups such as brand tribalism and brand love.

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

Research design constitutes the blueprint for the collection, measurement and analysis of data. It aids the researcher in the allocation of limited resources by posing crucial choices in methodology. It expresses the structure of the research problem- the framework, organization or configuration of the relationships among variables of a study and the plan of investigation used to obtain empirical evidence of those relationships. The appropriate design depends on the research objectives and the required data in attaining the same. Two extreme points of view can be known within the research methodology, quantitative and qualitative. Those who take the primary approach argue that there is a similarity between social and natural phenomena, and similar ways can be used to study each phenomenon.

Both Exploratory and Descriptive research design were used for the proposed study.

Exploratory Research: Initial research conducted to clarify and define the nature of a problem is called exploratory research.

1. Does not lead to any conclusive evidence.
2. Does not suggest particular course of action.
3. Subsequent research is needed.

Descriptive Research: Research designed to describe characteristics of a population or a phenomenon is called descriptive research.

1. Determines the answers to questions like: who, what, when, where, how.
2. Often helps in segmenting and targeting market.
3. Accuracy is very important.
4. Are based on some previous understanding of the nature of the problem.

3.1.1 Research methods: quantitative and qualitative research

The quantitative part of the study in this research includes the collection of primary data from the customers of various telecom service providers. For this purpose the data was collected from the customers of Madhya Pradesh region. A structured questionnaire was designed for this purpose, its process will be discussed in later part of this chapter. Both qualitative and the quantitative research methods were used to increase the depth of understanding of this research study.

3.1.2 Advantage of Quantitative Research Methodology

The quantitative research includes the collection of numeric data for this a well-designed structure of questionnaires is prepared and the answers are being collected from the consumers relevant to the study. In quantitative research, researcher can simply obtain the first-hand information straight from the researching field.

As, in this study researcher study about the word of mouth communication and services switching of the customers of telecom service providers. All of the study targets are those consumers who were connected with the telecom industries and are using various service providers. In the hypotheses testing process, quantitative research methodology plays a very crucial role while obtaining the final result. Other benefits of quantitative research are that the result is more observable after the analysis.

3.1.3 Disadvantages of Quantitative Research methodology

Quantitative research is always centred on the composed data analysis, so this is the reason that it constantly avoids the deep sense in concept ground. In the procedure of data collection, human features are occasionally not well measured. On other hand, the features decide that the more data being collected, the more exact the result will be. However, a systematic data collection needs time and personnel, so owing to the time and condition limit, the data is only from a specific sample size.

3.2 Objectives of the study

Evaluating the impact of Brand Tribalism on Brand Love. Brand Tribalism has significantly effects on Brand Love.

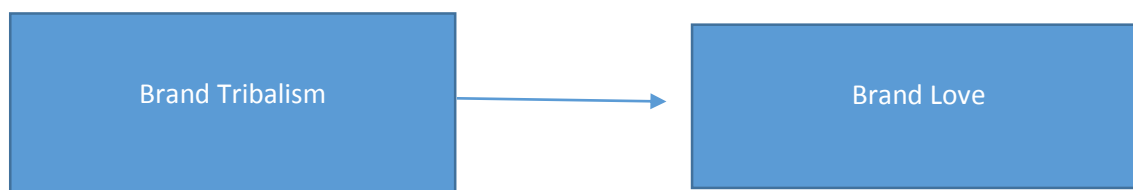
Based on the above mentioned objectives the hypotheses for the study were formed.

3.2.1 Hypotheses

H₁: Brand Tribalism has significantly effects on Brand Love.

3.2.2 Proposed research model for study

Figure 3.1: Proposed Model



3.3 Subject Selection and Sample

3.3.1 Population

The target population for this research is collected from Madhya Pradesh state for finding the impact of brand tribalism on the consumer behaviour. The survey only focused on the customers, who plays player Unknown's Battleground mobile online multiplayer battle royal game.

It is little bit difficult to gaining an accurate data, and the details of consumers who plays Pubg game. So the survey mixed the customers from various multiplayer battle royal game. Meanwhile the survey is sent to customer directly, and for not interrupting customers, only those customers who were present for some multiplayer battle royal game related reason

were selected for the survey. It is hard to obtain the opinion of those customers who do not directly present there.

3.3.2 Sampling

There are one data collection modes: self-administered questionnaires. It was difficult to select other data collection method due to global pandemic.

Therefore, in the current study the mode was selected on the basis of its aims and data required. This study required self-administered questionnaire as many variables needed to be explored. Here it is also important to mention that to accommodate there is one data collection mode: self-administered questionnaire. This mode has advantages and disadvantages associated within them.

Therefore, in the current study the mode was selected on the basis of its aims and data required. This study required self-administered questionnaire as many variables needed to be explored. Questionnaire was consisted of 40 questioners.

3.3.3 Sample Size and Response Rate

According to the amount of the customers in Central India region and the sample size formulation used for attribute sampling: the required sample size in the survey should be 200 cases ($n=200$) with $\text{Alpha}=0.05$. With the accurate calculation at the margin of errors Plus or Minus 3%, There totally 200 questionnaires were linked and distributed to the players' directly, with assumption that respondents may fill the questionnaire casually which will result in error. As expected 200 questionnaires were not filled correctly, out of which only 154 were found useable and surveys are valid and being collected, which is 80% response rate over the whole survey.

3.4 Questionnaire Development

Questionnaire is common instrument used in research in social sciences which contains specific questions with an aim of gathering relevant information and statistics from the participants. A structured questionnaire was developed to measure the effect of brand tribalism on consumer behavior. At the beginning of the questionnaire, personal request of

the researcher for filling up the questionnaire was asked. Some questions were included related to the basic demography of respondent for preparing respondent profile.

Table 3.4.1 displays the demographic questions asked in questionnaire.

<i>Table 3.4.1: Questions for demographic profile</i>		
Serial Number	Demography	Category
1	Name	
2	Gender	Male Female
3	Occupation	Student Service Self Employed
4	Email	Below 18 18-30 31 above

3.5 Tools for data analysis

There is a continuous verbal confrontation in quantitative research in regards to the utilization of either parametric or nonparametric measurable strategies. Trachtman, Giambalvo & Dippner, (1978) proposed that the utilization of either parametric or

nonparametric strategies relies on upon the presumptions identifying with the estimation scale (at any rate interim), ordinary dissemination, correspondence of change and examining. A researcher can utilize parametric procedures just if the information were regularly dispersed, information was gathered utilizing an estimation scale, difference covariance networks inside each one phone of the outline were examined from the same populace fluctuation covariance network, and the specimen size was dead set acknowledging the parametric strategies (Hair, et al., 1998). Trachtman, Giambalvo, & Dippner, (1978) contended that one may as well utilize parametric systems if these suppositions hold accurate, overall nonparametric procedures ought to be utilized. Siegel & Castellan (1988) remarkable that one may as well utilize nonparametric procedures just if there is not kidding mistrust about the suppositions underlying parametric systems since a nonparametric strategy is less capable than its parametric partner. Coakes & Steed (2001) exceptional that if the researcher reports genuine violations of the circulation presumptions of parametric systems then researcher might as well utilize non-parametric methods.

This study utilized a blending of parametric and non-parametric methods for information examination, as suspicions for parametric strategy were not met obviously and there were a few genuine violations reported. It is critical to say that the choice of information examination procedures in this study was commanded by the information dissection systems utilized within the past studies.

3.5.1 Validity and Reliability

As per Brown and Churchill (1996) "substance legitimacy is the sufficiency with which the significant parts of the aspects are caught by the measure". In the research, the poll was sent to online multiplayer battle royal game users of Gwalior. Additionally the substance legitimacy guaranteed the instrument completely incorporated the vital characteristics of the build that was being measured. When sending the poll, Quantities of written works survey was led to guarantee the critical inquiries are all pertinent in development of the association between Pubg mobile users and users steadfastness in online multiplayer battle royal game.

Chapter Summary

This chapter explains the methodology adopted and the methods employed for this piece of research giving appropriate justifications for the same. The chapter also discusses about the evaluating procedure for different aspects (dimensions) of consumer behaviour identified for this research. Methodological issues connected to research have also been justified.

DATA ANALYSIS

In this chapter, results from statistical analysis and outcomes of hypotheses testing are presented. This chapter presents the results of the analysis performed with the aim of describing the sample and testing the hypothesis formulated in chapter 3. The chapter is divided into various sections. It starts with reliability measures, profile of sample, Pearson's correlation and the regression analysis of the collected data.

4.1 Response Rate

In this research, the data was collected from the senior executives of banking sector in Madhya Pradesh, India. 200 questionnaires were distributed out of those 170 were returned and out of those 170 filled questionnaires 154 were found to be useful. This results in a response rate of 70%.

As an acceptable response rate, Babbie (1990) quoted 60% as 'good' and 70% as 'very good' (rules of thumb only). This study got overall 70% response rate, which means response rate was good to make further data analysis.

4.2 Sample Profile

In order to understand the sample profile the sample data was analysed with the help of 20.0. In the analyse category it is helpful to use the descriptive function for performing this procedure. It was clear to the researcher that all the efforts made in the data analysis become waste without understanding the sample profile. Sample profile helps to understand the system and patterns with different demographics.

4.2.1 Distribution of sample and frequencies of respondents

The total sample of customers consisted of 120 responses. With the help of cross tabulation researcher had identified that from which occupation how much data (in different categories) have been collected. Out of total respondents 98 (81.7%) males and 22 (18.3%) were females.

Table 4.5: Gender

Table 4.5: Gender

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	Male	133	83	83	83
	Female	21	17	17	100.0
	Total	154	100.0	100.0	

In this table 1, the male respondents had a frequency of 133 (83%) and the females had the frequency of 21 (17%).

Figure 4.1

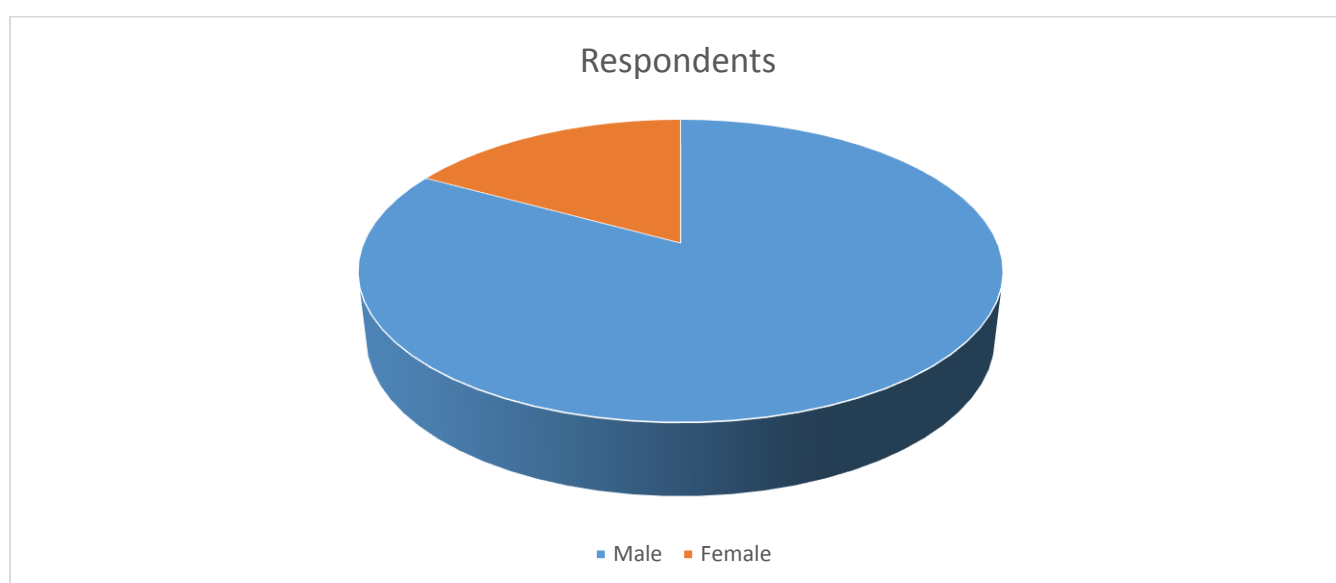


Table 4.4: Age

Table 4.4: Age

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	16-21	62	40	40	40
	21-25	85	55	55	95
	More than 25	7	5	5	100.0
	Total	154	100.0	100.0	

In the given table the frequency of 16-21 respondents are 62(40%). The frequency of age group of respondents between 21-25 are 85 (55%). The frequency of respondents above the age 25 are 7(5%).

Figure: 4.2

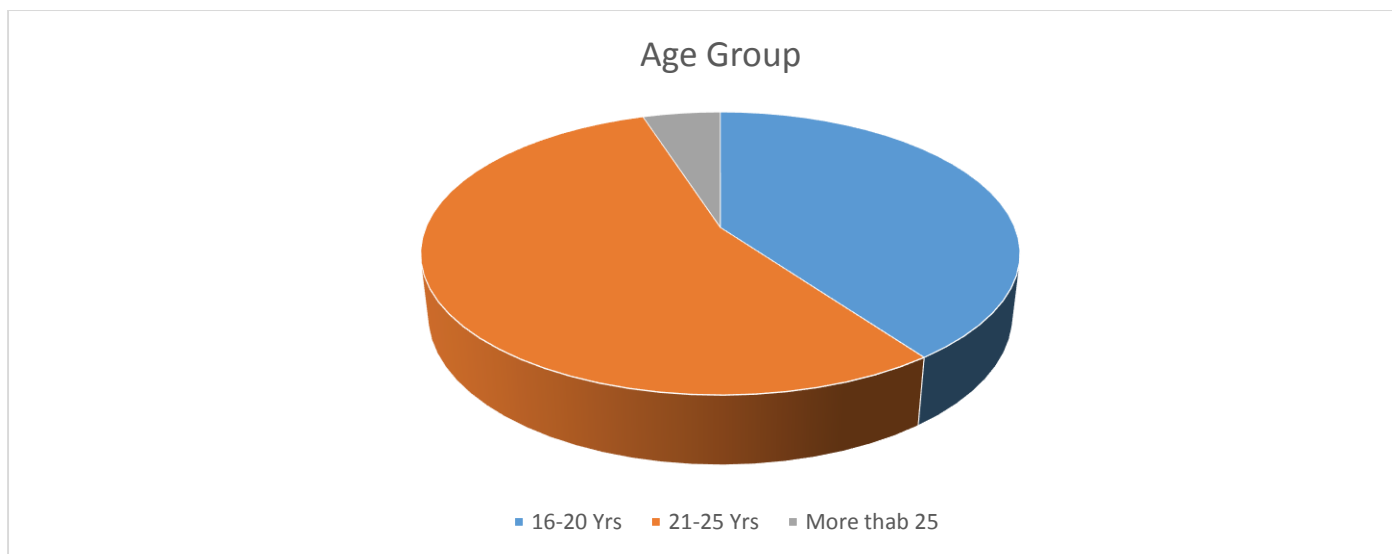


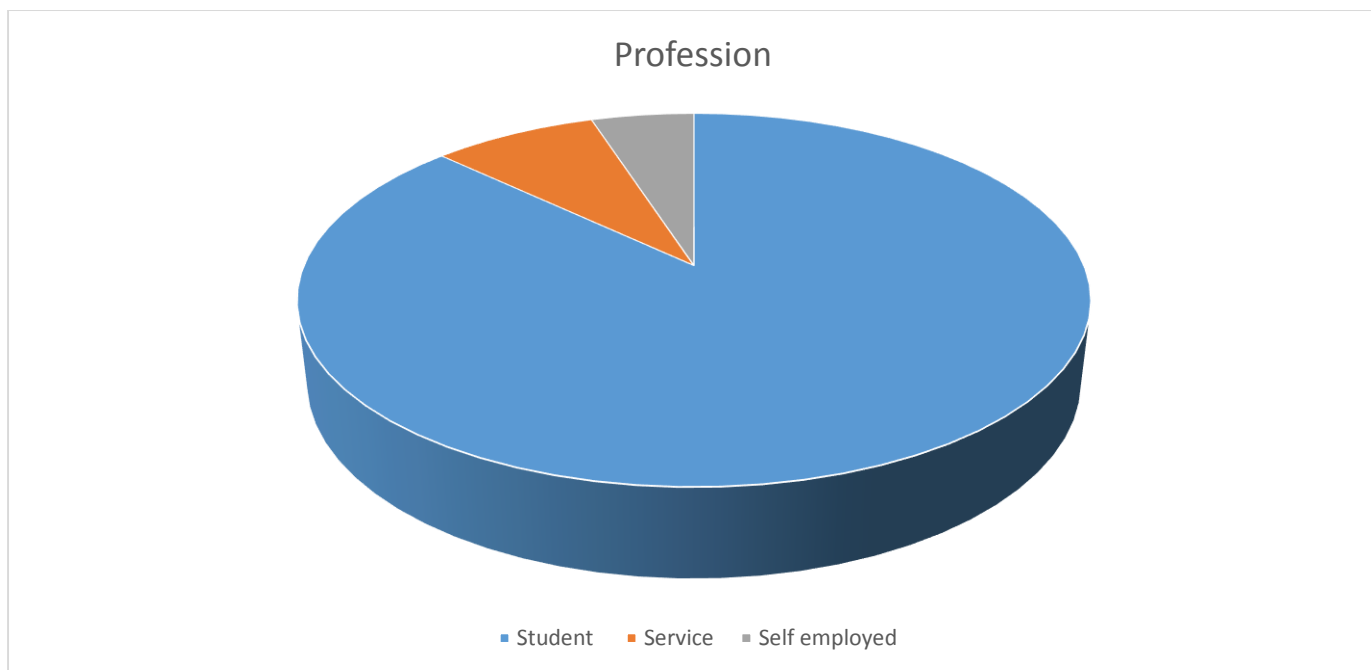
Table 4.5: Profession

Table 4.6: Salary

	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Student	133	87	87	87
Service	12	8	8	95
Self Employed	9	5	5	100

In the given table the frequency of respondents according to the Profession level is given. The frequencies of respondents having profession as students are 133(87%). The frequency of respondent's as service men are 12(8%) and respondents as self-employed are 9(5%).

Figure: 4.3



4.3 Reliability of the data

It is important to assess the reliability of instruments in order to design good scales for measurement. Reliability can be defined as the extent to which measures are free from error and thus yield consistent results (Zikmund, 1994). It is viewed that unwavering reliability more than .06 is considered great. The data set used in the study has reliability coefficient more than 0.6, thus indicating that the data collection is reliable.

Table 4.1: Reliability Statistics

Cronbach's Alpha	N of Items
.779	8

Table 4.3: Reliability Statistics

Cronbach's Alpha	N of Items
.930	5

4.4 Correlation between the variables

The most common relational statistic is known as correlation, and it is measurement of the strength of some relationship between two variables but not causality. Interpretation of a correlation coefficient does not even allow the slightest hint of causality.

Table:4. Correlations		Total Brand Tribalism	Total Brand Love
Total BT	Pearson Correlation	1	.525
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.000
	N	154	154
Total BL	Pearson Correlation	.525	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	
	N	154	154

Table 4.7 shows the correlation between the variables used in the study. In the study the researcher found a moderate and positive relationship between brand tribalism with brand love ' r ' = 0.525, indicating that there is positive association between both the variables. It can be easily understood by the table 4.7 that our variable is positively associated with other.

4.5 Testing of hypotheses

This section of the chapter deals with testing of hypotheses mentioned in the chapter 3. Following are the proposed hypotheses:

H1: Brand Tribalism has significant effect on Brand Love among the players.

4.6 Regression between the variables

Regression analysis is used to find out the relationship between dependent variables. It is a statistical tool to find out whether two variables are related to each other and one variable effects another variable.

4.6.1 H1: H1: Brand Tribalism has significant effect on Brand Love among the players.

Table 4.9: Model Summary				
Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	.525 ^a	.275	.271	6.574
a. Predictors: (Constant), Total BT_Total				

Table 4.10: ANOVA ^a						
Model		Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
1	Regression	2496.269	1	2496.269	57.756	.000 ^b
	Residual	6569.627	152	43.221		
	Total	9065.896	153			
a. Dependent Variable: BL_Total						
b. Predictors: (Constant), BT_Total						

Table 4.11: Coefficients						
Model		Unstandardized Coefficients		Standardized Coefficients	t	Sig.
		B	Std. Error	Beta		
1	(Constant)	2.552	.632		1.260	.000
	Total BT	.818	.044	.867	7.600	.000
a. Dependent Variable: BL Total						

The effect of brand tribalism on brand love is examined through table 4.8, 4.9 and 4.10.

These tables' exhibits the statistical inferences made from the collected data. It is indicated

from the table 4.8 and 4.9 that brand tribalism account for 27.5% of variance on brand love among the players of battle royal games. ($R^2=0.275$, $\Delta R^2:0..271$, $F(1,152)= 57.756$, $p>0.05$).

It was found that brand tribalism significantly predicts the brand love by the players of battle royal games ($\beta=.818$, $p= .000$). It indicates that there is a positive and strong relationship between brand tribalism and brand love.

Table 4.14: Status of the hypotheses

No.	Statement	Status
H1	Brand Tribalism has significant effect on Brand Love among the players.	Supported

CHAPTER 5

IMPLICATIONS, LIMITATIONS & CONCLUSIONS

5.1 Implications of the study

This research is intended to be useful for further research studies where researchers want to understand the impact of brand tribalism on brand love. Thus this research could be used by the service providers who are willing to enhance their brand love. This research provides insights to the managers about brand tribalism and its impact on brand love. The study indicates that service industry focus on brand tribalism and enhance the brand love.

This study is useful contributing towards developing the brand love of service sector. The service provider will gain the insight about content which should be developed for brand tribalism.

Reference of study can also be help for the students for their research. This research can be used as reference for students who wish to explore paradigms of brand tribalism on brand love.

The developed questionnaire can be used for further research. This questionnaire can be used by researchers for further studies for exploring areas of brand tribalism and its impact on brand love.

5.2 Limitations

The study was based upon only 154 respondents, if more number of respondents are included then more accurate results may be expected. If the number of respondents could have been more the results could have been more accurate and there would have been wide acceptability of the results

The study was carried out only in Gwalior region. The study should be carried out on other different cities as well. Thus, the effect of brand tribalism on brand love can be known amongst different backdrops. The players' comparisons should also be carried out so that the results could have been generalized.

The study only examined components of brand tribalism and its impact on brand love and more set of variables could have been included in the study so that more thorough study of variables can be done and inferences could be made.

5.3 Conclusion

This section of the study contains description of each objective desired in the study and their status.

OBJ 1: To identify whether brand tribalism effects on brand love among the players.
Achieved

Brand tribalism has been described by various scholars as an important factor which effects the brand love. But the results of the study indicate that there was a positive correlation between the brand tribalism and brand love.

Research Project Summary

The study has been divided into five chapters. The first chapter of this study was Introduction which includes four sub-parts namely conceptual framework, Literature Review, Rationale and Objectives. In conceptual framework all definitions and introduction about the topic was there. In literature review all researchers have been mentioned which has been done previously, rationale has helped to understand the need & importance of the study i.e. why we are doing this research, then next part was objectives of this research which includes all the objects of this research, Second chapter is review of literature, which includes review of research papers, third chapter is research design which includes sample design consisting population, sample design consisting population, sample size, sampling element, sampling technique and tool used for data collection (standardized questionnaire). The tools used are Cronbach Alfa reliability coefficient, Pearson's correlation and multiple regression has been applied. Fourth chapter contains Results and Discussion fifth chapter is Summary and Conclusion and in the end References and Annexure are placed.

BIBLIOGRAPY

Anderson B (1991) *Imagined Communities: Reflections on the Origin and Spread of Nationalism*. London; New York: Verso.

Arruda-Filho EJM and Lennon MM (2011) How iPhone innovators changed their consumption in iDay2: Hedonic post or brand devotion. *International Journal of Information Management* 31(6): 524–532.

Baudrillard J (1981 [1972]) *For a Critique of the Political Economy of the Sign*. St Louis, MO: Telos Press.

Bauman Z (2001) *Community: Seeking Safety in an Insecure World*. Cambridge: Polity Press.

Bryan W (2005 [1998]) Xenatopia. In: Keetley D and Pettegrew J (eds) *Public Women, Public Words, Volume III: A Documentary History of American Feminism*. Lanham, MD: Rowman & Littlefield Publishers, Inc., pp. 386–388.

Burgh-Woodman HD and Brace-Govan J (2007) We do not live to buy: Why subcultures are different from brand communities and the meaning for marketing discourse. *International Journal of Sociology and Social Policy* 27: 193–207.

Carlson BD, Suter TA and Brown TJ (2008) Social versus psychological brand community: The role of psychological sense of brand community. *Journal of Business Research* 61: 284–291.

Cohen AP (1985) *The Symbolic Construction of Community*. New York: Tavistock Publications.

Cova B and Pace S (2006) Brand community of convenience products: New forms of customer empowerment: The case ‘‘my Nutella The Community.’’. *European Journal of Marketing* 40: 1087–1105.

Cova B and Cova V (2001) Tribal aspects of postmodern consumption research: The case of French in-line roller skaters. *Journal of Consumer Behaviour* 1(1): 67–76.

Cova B and Cova V (2002) Tribal marketing: The tribalisation of society and its impact on the conduct of marketing. *European journal of marketing* 36(5–6): 595–620.

Cova B, Kozinets R and Shankar A (2007) *Consumer Tribes*. Oxford: Butterworth-Heinemann.

Cova B and White T (2010) Counter-brand and alter-brand communities: the impact of Web 2.0 on tribal marketing approaches. *Journal of Marketing Management* 26(3–4): 256–270.

Davidson L, Mcneill L and Ferguson S (2007) Magazine communities: Brand community formation in magazine consumption. *International Journal of Sociology* 27: 208–220.

Delanty G (2003) *Community*. New York: Routledge.

Durkheim E (1965) *The Elementary Forms of the Religious Life* (trans. JW Swain). New York: Free Press.

Fiske J (1989) *Understanding Popular Culture*. Boston, MA: Unwin Hyman.

Frith S (1996) Music and identity. In: Hall S and Du Gay P (eds) *Questions of Cultural Identity*. London: Sage, pp. 108–127.

Goulding C, Shankar A and Elliott R (2002) Working weeks, rave weekends: Identity fragmentation and the emergence of new communities. *Consumption, Markets and Culture* 5(4): 261–284.

Gusfield JR (1975) *The Community: A Critical Response*. New York: Harper Colophon.

Haenfler R (2004) Rethinking subcultural resistance: Core values of the straight edge movement. *Journal of Contemporary Ethnography* 33(4): 406–436.

Harries-Jones P (1969) “Home-boy” ties and political organization in a copperbelt township. In: Mitchell JC (ed.) *Social Networks in Urban Situations: Analyses of Personal Relationships in Central African Towns*. Manchester: Manchester University Press, pp. 297–347.

Hatch M and Schultz M (2008) *Taking Brand Initiative: How Companies Can Align Strategy, Culture, and Identity through Corporate Branding*. San Francisco, CA: Jossey-Bass.

Hill JS and Vincent J (2006) Globalisation and sports branding: The case of Manchester United. *International Journal of Sports Marketing & Sponsorship* 7(3): 213–230.

Holt D (2004) *How Brands Become Icons: The Principles of Cultural Branding*. Boston, MA: Harvard Business School Press.

Holt D (2006) Jack Daniel’s America: Iconic brands as ideological parasites and proselytizers. *Journal of Consumer Culture* 6(3): 355–377.

Kharpal A and Bishop K (2013) Soccer wins send Manchester United shares soaring. CNBC, 9 August. Available at: <http://www.cnbc.com/id/100952165>

Lee M (2000) *Introduction: The Consumer Society Reader*. Oxford: Blackwell Publishers.

Leigh TW, Peters C and Shelton J (2006) The consumer quest for authenticity: The multiplicity of meanings within the MG subculture of consumption. *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science* 34: 481–493.

- Maffesoli M (1996) *The Time of the Tribes: The Decline of Individualism in Mass Society*. London: Sage.
- Muñiz AM and O’Guinn TC (2001) Brand community. *Journal of Consumer Research* 27:412–431.
- Nancy J-L (1991) *The Inoperative Community*. Minneapolis, MN: University of Minnesota Press.
- O’Reilly D (2011) Leisure tribe-onomics. In: Cameron S (ed.) *Handbook on the Economics of Leisure*. Cheltenham: Edward Elgar Publishing, pp. 239–249.
- O’Reilly D (2012) Maffesoli and consumer tribes: Developing theoretical links. *Marketing Theory* 12: 341–347.
- Pongsakornrungrasri S and Schroeder J (2011) Understanding value co-creation in a co-consuming brand community. *Marketing Theory* 11(3): 303–324.
- Rosenbaum MS (2013) Maintaining the Trail Collective Action in a Serious-Leisure Community. *Journal of Contemporary Ethnography* 42(6): 639–667.
- Schau HJ, Muñiz AM and Arnould EJ (2009) How brand community practices create value. *Journal of Marketing* 73(5): 30–51.
- Schouten JW and McAlexander JH (1995) Subcultures of consumption: An ethnography of the new biker. *Journal of Consumer Research* 22(1): 43–61.
- Stein SR (2002) The ‘1984’ Macintosh Ad: Cinematic Icons and Constitutive Rhetoric in the Launch of a New Machine. *Quarterly Journal of Speech* 88(2): 169–192.
- Toennies F (1957) *Community and Society*. New York: HarperCollins Publishers.
- Turner V (1967) *The Forest of Symbols: Aspects of Ndembu Ritual*. New York: Cornell University Press.

ANNEXURE I-

QUESTIONNAIRE

Table 3.4.1: Questions for demographic profile

Serial Number	Demography	Category

1	Name	
2	Gender	Male Female
3	Occupation	Student Service Self Employed
4	Email	Below 18 18-30 31 above

Table 3.4.2 displays variables which are asked in questionnaire. All the 40 questions which were asked in questionnaire and the variable they measured are displayed in the table exhibited next.

<i>Table 3.4.2: Variables and their sequence in questionnaire</i>		
Serial. No	Questions	Sequence in questionnaire
18.	This battle royal game is like a person with whom I am close to	
19.	Both, this battle royal game and I benefit from our association.	

20. Over time, this battle royal game becomes more important to me
 21. I have a sense of belonging to this battle royal game
 22. I have psychological attachment to this battle royal game
 23. I think that exchanging opinion with others who play this battle royal game is important
 24. I expect that I will continuously participate in battle royal game
 25. I am an actively participating member of this battle royal game
 26. I am strongly passionate about this battle royal game
 27. This battle royal game induces strong passion in me
 28. I waited long to put this battle royal game into my possession.
 29. I may make necessary sacrifices to acquire this battle royal game.
 30. I consider myself to be loyal to this Battle royal game.
 31. This Battle royal game would be my first choice
 32. I will not install other games if this Battle royal game is available at the play store
 33. Playing this battle royal game makes me very happy
 - 34.
-

I love this battle royal game

-
- 35. This battle royal game is a pure delight
 - 36. I am passionate about this battle royal game.
 - 37. I'm very attached to this battle royal game
 - 38. I am proud of my battle royal game community
 - 39. I elevate the image of my battle royal game community
 - 40. I Bring prestige to my battle royal game community